

Learning Intention: I can discuss how characters, settings and events in a story are shown, and how they add meaning to the text.

Success Criteria — I can:

- Describe a character using details from the story.
- Describe the setting and explain how it affects the story.
- Explain how a key event affects a character or the story's meaning.

Reading Strategy

As you read, notice how the author describes **characters** (who is in the story and what they're like), the **setting** (where and when it happens), and the **events** (what happens and why it matters).

Read — The Creek Crossing

Mia crouched at the edge of the creek, her sneakers sinking slightly into the cool, muddy bank. The water moved slowly here, brown and quiet, winding between tall gum trees that cast long shadows across the surface. She had crossed this creek a hundred times on the old wooden footbridge, but today the bridge was closed for repairs, its planks roped off with bright orange tape.

"We'll have to find another way across," said Mia's older brother, Tom, scanning the bank. He wasn't usually one to take risks, but he hated being late, and their grandmother's house was just on the other side.

Further downstream, they found a row of smooth, flat stones poking just above the water. Mia hesitated. The stones looked slippery, and the creek, though shallow, still made a soft gurgling sound as it pushed past.

"I'll go first," Tom said, and stepped carefully onto the nearest stone. One by one, they crossed — wobbling, laughing nervously, but making it to the other side with only wet shoes to show for it. Mia grinned. It wasn't the bridge, but it had gotten them there all the same.

Vocabulary Helper

Word	Meaning
Character	A person (or animal) in a story
Setting	Where and when a story takes place
Event	Something that happens in a story

Parent Tip

After reading any story together, ask three simple questions: "Who was in it? Where did it happen? What was the big moment?" This builds the exact skill this worksheet is teaching.

Widen Your Reading

This skill — noticing character, setting and event — applies to every story you read, including wonderful books by First Nations Australian authors. Ask your teacher or librarian to recommend one to read next.

Find It, Think About It & Apply

Q1 — Find It (Literal)

- a) Who are the two characters in the story? _____
- b) Where does the story take place? _____
- c) Why couldn't Mia and Tom use the footbridge? _____

Q2 — Think About It (Inferred)

- a) How do you think Mia felt when she saw the slippery stones? Use a clue from the text.

- b) Why does the author mention that Tom "hated being late"? _____

Q3 — Describe the Character

Fill in the table using details and clues from the story.

Character	What we know about them
Tom	
Mia	

Q4 — How Does the Setting Affect the Story?

Setting detail	How it affects the story
The closed footbridge	
The slippery stones in the creek	

Watch Out!

A character's personality isn't always stated directly — often you have to **infer** it from what they say and do. Tom doesn't say "I am brave," but stepping onto the stones first shows it.

Q5 — True or False?

Statement	True / False
The setting of a story can create a problem the characters must solve.	True / False
A character's actions can show their personality, even without being told directly.	True / False

Apply & Reasoning — Use what you've read to explain your thinking.

- 1 Reasoning:** How would the story be different if the footbridge had NOT been closed? Explain how this one setting detail shapes the whole story.

- 2 Reasoning:** What does Tom's decision to go first tell you about his character? Use evidence from the text.

- 3 Open-ended:** Invent a new character who joins Mia and Tom at the creek. Describe them, and write one new event that happens because of them.

Quick Check — Exit Ticket

Name one word that describes Mia or Tom, and one clue from the story that supports it.

Answer & Teacher Support

Answer Key — Pages 1 & 2

Q1 (p2): a) Mia and Tom. b) At a creek, near an old wooden footbridge, close to their grandmother's house. c) It was closed for repairs.

Q2 (p2): a) Accept e.g. nervous/cautious — she "hesitated" and thought the stones "looked slippery". b) It shows why Tom is motivated to find another way across quickly, explaining his decision to try the stones.

Q3 (p2): Tom — cautious/responsible but determined, doesn't like being late, brave enough to go first. Mia — a little nervous/hesitant, but willing to follow and try.

Q4 (p2): Closed footbridge — forces the characters to find another way, creating the story's main problem. Slippery stones — creates tension/risk and a chance for the characters to show courage.

Q5 (p2): "Setting can create a problem" — True. "Actions can show personality without being told directly" — True.

Answer Key — Page 3

Q1 (acceptable-answer guide): Accept any response recognising that without the closed bridge, there would be no problem to solve and no stepping-stone crossing scene — the setting detail creates the whole plot.

Q2: It shows Tom is brave/willing to take the lead and take a small risk for his sister and brother, even though he's usually cautious.

Q3 (acceptable-answer guide): Accept any original character description and a new event that logically fits the story's setting and existing characters.

Exit ticket: Accept any accurate character word supported by a genuine textual clue (e.g. "cautious — Tom hesitated before finding another way").

Teacher Checklist

- ☐ Retrieves literal facts about characters and setting.
- ☐ Makes reasonable inferences about character feelings and motives.
- ☐ Describes characters using evidence from the text.
- ☐ Explains how setting shapes the story's events.
- ☐ Creates an original character/event that fits the story world.

Teacher Tip

This worksheet builds the character/setting/event analysis skill required by AC9E3LE01 using an original text. The curriculum specifically highlights texts by First Nations Australian authors for this code — pair this skill practice with a genuine First Nations-authored picture book or story from your school library to fully meet the descriptor's intent.